



Seagate 100GB

implementation and utilisation, is far superior to that of the Transcend drives.

The King of Space: Without a doubt, the Seagate 100 GB is the clear winner. The drive is exceptionally fast and has a huge cache, not to mention the massive 100 GB it can store, and is priced at a very competitive Rs 13,000—just Rs 1,000 rupees more than the Seagate 5 GB pocket drive.

The drive that came in second by a reasonable margin was the WD 40 GB Passport. It is a really good performer, and is eminently comparable to the



Western Digital Passport 40 GB

Seagate except when it comes to size, where it lucks out at a mere 40 GB. The WD Passport is priced very reasonably at Rs 6,400, and is, in fact, cheaper than the Transcend 20 GB—priced at Rs 8,320.

Comparing the WD Passport to the Seagate: if you buy two of these WD drives, you'll be paying Rs 12,800 for 80 GB of space, whereas the Seagate 100 GB gives you a cool 20 GB of additional space at virtually the same cost—Rs 13,000.

For overall performance, price and features, the Seagate 100 GB portable HDD gets the Digit Best Buy Gold Award. The Western Digital 40 GB Passport comes in a comfortable second to receive the Digit Best Buy Silver Award.

DESKTOP STORAGE/BACKUP SOLUTIONS

Looks, Size And Build

In our desktop storage/backup segment, all the drives were very bulky, and seemed even more so when compared to the portable drives we've been talking about so far. In terms of looks, nothing beat the Seagate drives with their sturdy, square exteriors. The quality of materials that make up the outer casing is excellent, and the use of high-grade plastic makes the drives sturdy and also light. Their design also enables stacking of one drive on top of another.

That's not to say that the Seagates were the sturdiest of the

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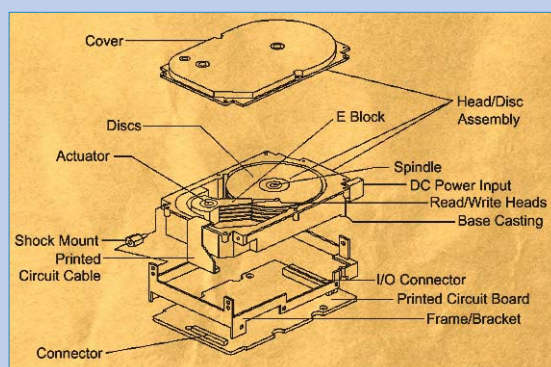
How Hard Disk Drives Work

A hard disk essentially consists of a flat plate-like object that is polished to achieve a mirror-like effect. This is the hard disk's platter, and this is where the data is actually stored using the magnetic properties of the material the platter is made of.

Hard disks of today feature multiple platters. Each platter usually has a read/write head attached to it, which in turn is attached to an arm or actuator that moves the head over the platter.

Writing is achieved by subjecting the platter to a magnetic flux by the write head, which leads to the change of polarisation on the platter. The process is reversed for reading—the magnetic field of the platter affects that of the read head, and this is interpreted as data.

A platter and a head can be thought of as the gramophones and record players of yesteryear, where the needle moved on the



record to read the record and play the song. The case is pretty much the same here, except the read/write heads don't touch the platter—they fly less than a hairsbreadth above it.

The platter can spin at roughly 3,000 inches a second, which is approximately 270 kmph! Today, hard disks generally run at 5,400 or 7,200 rpm, though you do get hard drives where the platter spins at 15,000 rpm!